

New Career Services Platform: UT Dallas is moving from Handshake to 12twenty 

Job & Internship Search Strategies for International Students

[UT Dallas](#) > [University Career Center](#) > [Career Resource Library](#) > **International Students**

On This Page

Learning About U.S. Visa Regulations & Work Authorization
Working On-Campus
Internship Search
Networking
Building Skills
Cultural Differences in the Job Search
Revealing Your Immigration Status to U.S. Employers
Resources for International Students

At the University Career Center, we understand the unique challenges and opportunities that international students face in their career journey. We are here to help you with your career preparation.

[INTERNATIONAL STUDENT VIDEO OVERVIEW](#) 

[INTERNATIONAL STUDENT VIDEO GUIDE](#) 

Whether you are a current student or alumni, the UCC exists to help get you started in your career from personalized career advising to career fairs and everything in-between. Partner with us as you explore majors and careers, identify experiential learning opportunities, prepare your resume and cover letter, and practice your interviewing skills.

[SCHEDULE AN APPOINTMENT](#) 

Learning About U.S. Visa Regulations & Work Authorization

Being familiar with up-to-date U.S. visa regulations is important. Visas have different on-campus, off-campus, and post-graduation requirements. Many international students may have F-1 or J-1 visa status, and each of these visas have different on-campus, off-campus, and post-graduation requirements.

You are strongly encouraged to visit the [International Students & Scholars Office](#) (ISSO), which provides immigration information and support to UT Dallas students through workshops and individual student advising.

Employment opportunities for F-1 and J-1 international students are restricted. A few key things to be aware of:

- Never accept or engage in paid or unpaid off-campus employment, internships, fellowships, or other training without prior authorization from the International Students & Scholars Office. You can learn more about work authorizations, including Curricular Practical Training (CPT), Optional Practical Training (OPT), and Academic Training (AT) on the [ISSO website](#).
 - **Curricular Practical Training (CPT)**: Allows international students to gain work experience before graduation.
 - **Optional Practical Training (OPT)**: A one-year work authorization after graduation, with a 24-month extension for STEM majors.
 - **H-1B Visa**: A common work visa for international graduates seeking long-term employment in the U.S.
- Understand your visa status and what types of employment authorizations are available to you in order to clearly communicate your work authorization eligibility to the employer.

Working On-Campus

The University of Texas at Dallas employs more than 2,000 students annually to assist with daily operations, planning, and other activities for the benefit of the institution and the local community. It is our privilege to help our students gain transferable skills, earn supplemental income, and experience working in professional environments through meaningful on and off-campus employment opportunities.

All approved jobs, including student employment positions, are posted on 12twenty.

To apply for jobs using 12twenty:

- Log into [12twenty](#) using your NetID and password.
- From the side menu bar, select Job Listings & Interviews > Search > (Optional) Filter by Work Authorization, Industry, Major, Location, etc.

Internship Search

According to the National Association of Colleges & Employers (NACE), an internship is a form of experiential learning that integrates knowledge and theory learned in the classroom with practical application and skills development in a professional setting.

If your visa permits, obtain an internship to gain some experience in your chosen career field. This experience will come in handy when looking for a full-time job. International students may engage in experiential learning opportunities, such as internships, during any academic term as long as the experience has been approved as relevant to their degree program.

Searching for and obtaining an appropriate internship is highly valuable to the overall career development process. We encourage students to start the internship search early to help identify career interests and goals. Our office provides multiple online resources to help guide students through the internship search process.

Work closely with the [International Students & Scholars Office](#) to understand CPT requirements for internships.

Networking

As an international student who may have fewer contacts in the U.S., it is important to build and maintain networks that can support your job search. Networking is based on making meaningful connections that are mutually beneficial, which can be achieved through clearly communicating some combination of your interests, skills, goals, and experiences.

In the U.S., it is very common to contact someone who is currently working in your area of interest and speak with them to ask for advice. UT Dallas alumni are also great resources for career advice and informational interviews. This directness in communication is valued in the U.S. [LinkedIn](#) is a valuable resource for your job or internship search, especially for growing and maintaining your network. You can utilize the LinkedIn Alumni feature to find and connect with UT Dallas alumni.

According to Indeed, following these networking tips can increase your confidence:

- Talk to new people at networking events
- Attend new events
- Create authentic relationships
- Bring a memorable business card
- Be confident

- Stay connected
- Help others in your network
- Revisit older connections
- Find new connections online
- Form your own networking group

Source: [10 Tips to Help You Network Like a Pro](#) 

Building Skills

In addition to related technical or functional experience and knowledge, employers look for communication, leadership, and interpersonal skills acquired in a variety of settings. These can be developed through involvement in student organizations, student employment, volunteer experiences, internships, enrolling in courses with group projects, or developing friendships with students of different backgrounds.

Review the skills employers are looking for on a candidate's resume by visiting our complete resume guide.

Cultural Differences in the Job Search

Being aware of differences in cultural norms can better help you understand and navigate the job search process in both the United States and abroad. Below are common cultural norms you may encounter when job searching in the United States, as well as variations that may exist in other cultures.

Cultural Norms	Common U.S. Employer Expectations	Common Values in Other Cultures
Self-Promotion	Talking openly about skills and sharing examples of past excellent performance.	Sharing specific skills, strengths and accomplishments might be seen as boastful.
Body Language	A firm handshake shows confidence; direct eye contact is expected and is seen as showing honesty and confidence.	A light or limp handshake might be more common. Handshakes or touching between men and women may be seen as inappropriate in some cultures. Direct eye contact may be seen as disrespectful.
Informality and Self-Disclosure	Questions regarding likes, dislikes, and hobbies are not unusual. Interviews may be conversational and include humor or joking.	Questions about likes, dislikes, or hobbies might be seen as an invasion of privacy or inappropriate. Interviews may be more formal.
Resumes	Resumes are typically 1–2 pages and tailored to the specific job or field. Date of birth, marital status, gender, and photos would never be included.	Resumes are often called Curriculum Vitae (CV) and include a more comprehensive overview of all experience and education.
Follow Up	Following up after interview via thank you notes, calls, or emails to determine the status of an application is considered appropriately assertive.	Asking an employer about the status of a job application can be seen as rude.
Note:	These values do not represent one particular culture, but those that may be true across a variety of cultures around the world.	Source: Cultural Differences in the Job Search ^[2]

Revealing Your Immigration Status to U.S. Employers

“When in the hiring process do I need to reveal my immigration status?”

This is a very sensitive question that needs to be assessed on a case-by-case basis. When asked, it is essential to respond honestly about your immigration status and work authorization eligibility and ensure that the topic is discussed.

Make a Backup Plan

Expand your pool of opportunities by applying for positions abroad. Explore where your education and experiences are in demand, and be open to options you previously had not considered.

Resources for International Students

Resumes & Cover Letters

Interviewing

Self-Marketing

Pathway to Professionalism Digital Badge Program

Additional Job Search Resources

The University of Texas at Dallas

University Career Center

Student Services Building 3.300
800 W. Campbell Road
Richardson, Texas 75080-3021

972-883-2943

EVENTS

OCT
6

UCC - Comet Trek (Employer Site Visit) with Medpace

OCT
7

UCC- Deep Ellum Foundation Tabling

OCT
7

UCC: CVS Health Information Session

OCT
8

UCC- Teach for America Tabling

OCT
8

UCC: Fifth Third Bank- Panel and Networking Event



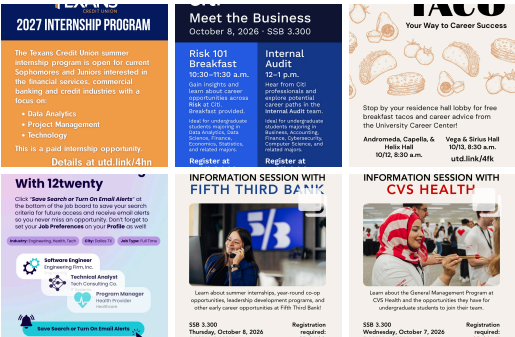
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